Managing Context Window Limits & Multi-Turn Chat Drift

Question: During a long 25-turn debugging conversation in GitHub Copilot Chat, a developer attaches five large 2,000-line files using `#file` and notices that Copilot begins forgetting constraints established in the earliest messages and producing degraded answers. What is causing this behavior, and what is the best corrective action?

A. GitHub Copilot throttles model accuracy after 20 prompts per day per developer seat.

B. The accumulated conversation history and large file attachments exceed the model's finite token context window, causing earlier turns to be truncated or summarized; starting a new Chat thread (`/clear` or *New Chat*) with focused `#selection` context resolves it. **[CORRECT ANSWER]**

C. Content Exclusions automatically activate once a file exceeds 1,500 lines of code.

D. Running `@terminal` resets the LLM's token budget without losing earlier chat messages.

Explanation & Exam Rationale

Every foundation model backing GitHub Copilot operates with a bounded **context window** measured in tokens (which must fit system instructions, custom instructions, attached `#file` / `#selection` snippets, conversation history, the user's current prompt, and the generated output). As a thread grows or large files are attached, Copilot must truncate or compress older conversation history—leading to context drift.

Best Practice	Effect on Token Budget	Why It Improves Accuracy
Start a New Chat Thread (when switching tasks)	Clears stale multi-turn history tokens	Eliminates conflicting instructions and outdated error traces from earlier turns
Use `#selection` instead of huge `#file`	Injects only targeted functions/lines	Maximizes signal-to-noise ratio inside the prompt window
Decompose Complex Tasks	Keeps input + output generation compact	Prevents output truncation and yields cleaner, testable incremental diffs

Key Exam Takeaway: More context is not always better—attaching oversized, irrelevant files dilutes attention and forces truncation of earlier conversation turns. Use **New Chat** for distinct subtasks and scope attachments tightly.